

# Anaconda and Python Installation — Troubleshooting

*Quick note: if you already tried to install Anaconda in class and it didn't work, skip to the last section, **Uninstalling**, and follow the instructions there. Then start again from scratch.*

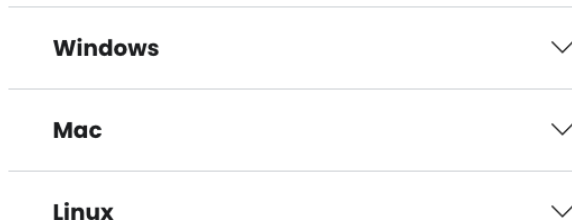
## Windows

1. Go to <https://www.anaconda.com/download> and click **Get Started**. Sign in with your TCD Gmail account (not required, just quicker).
2. Click the green **Download for [your OS]** button (the screenshot below is from a Mac, but your operating system should be detected automatically).

### Distribution Installers



For installation assistance, refer to [troubleshooting](#).



3. Run the installer.
  - a. You'll be prompted to choose an install location — a folder named `anaconda3`. Accept this.
  - b. There's a box labelled **Add Anaconda to my PATH** that is recommended to be left **unchecked**. Several installation problems today were caused by following that recommendation. If you had trouble earlier, try reinstalling with this box **checked**.
  - c. Installation can take 15–20 minutes on an older machine or one with lots of installed programs/files. Don't stop the installation — only abort if it's taking noticeably longer than that.
  - d. Keep **Launch Anaconda Navigator** checked before the installer window closes.
4. After the installation finishes, look for **Anaconda Prompt** in your Windows search bar. If it's not there, open **Anaconda Navigator** (which should have launched

automatically at the end of step 3d), find **Anaconda Prompt**, and click **Launch**. If neither shows up, the installation needs to be redone. First remove the anaconda3 folder — see the **Uninstalling** section before proceeding.

5. Once Anaconda Prompt opens, confirm conda is installed correctly. Type: `conda --version` You should see `conda 24.11.3` (or a later version) printed.
6. Then type: `python --version` You should see `Python 3.11.7` (or a later version) printed.
7. Create an environment by typing: `conda create -n codecamp python=3.12 -y`  
Wait to see something like this (screenshot from macOS — small differences may appear on Windows):

```
Downloading and Extracting Packages:
```

```
Preparing transaction: done
Verifying transaction: done
Executing transaction: done
#
# To activate this environment, use
#
#     $ conda activate testenv
#
# To deactivate an active environment, use
#
#     $ conda deactivate
```

8. Activate your environment by typing: `conda activate codecamp` (The screenshot below shows `testenv` because it was recorded in a different environment — your console should print `codecamp` instead.)
9. Confirm it worked: the prompt should change from `(base)` to `(codecamp)`, as shown here:

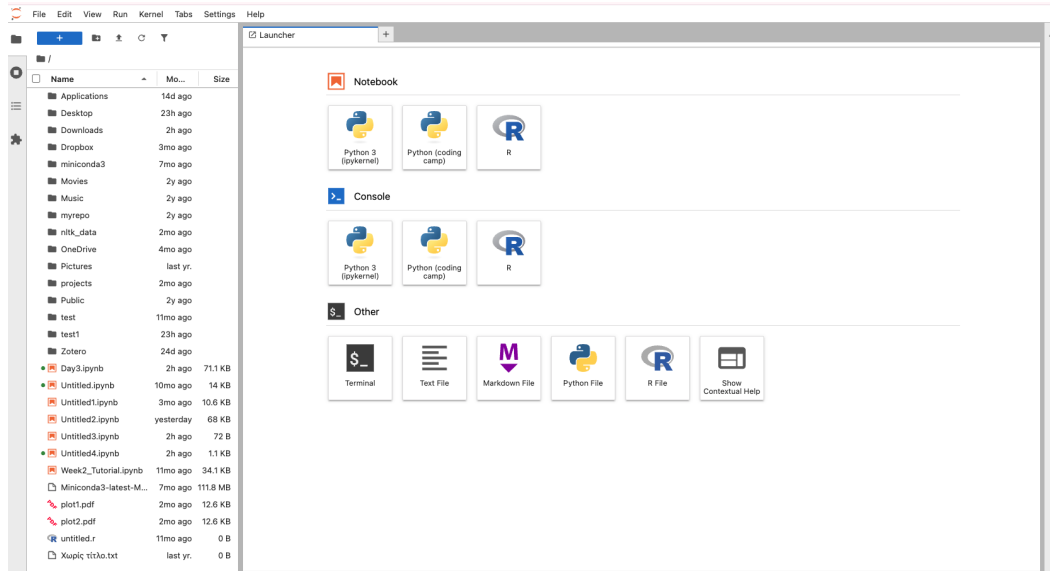
```
(base) elkarag@MacBook-Air-Eleni ~ % conda activate testenv
(testenv) elkarag@MacBook-Air-Eleni ~ % █
```

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10. Next, install JupyterLab:

- a. Type `conda install -y jupyterlab ipykernel`
- b. Open it by typing `jupyter lab`
- c. You may be prompted to choose a browser to open it in — pick whichever you like.

11. You should see something like this:



**If something doesn't work, don't panic.** Check spelling very carefully, along with the exact typing of commands, spacing between words, etc. Try copying and pasting the commands exactly as written above.

If the problem persists, try uninstalling Anaconda and going through the process again (see the **Uninstalling** section below).

**If you're still facing issues, please email me at [karagiae@tcd.ie](mailto:karagiae@tcd.ie) to arrange a quick meeting to resolve any remaining issues.**

## macOS

1. Go to <https://www.anaconda.com/download> and click **Get Started**. Sign in with your TCD Gmail account (not required, just quicker).
2. Click the green **Download for Mac** button. If your Mac has an Apple Silicon chip (M1 or later), download the Apple Silicon version. If it has an Intel processor, download the Intel version.
  - a. To check which chip your Mac has, click the Apple menu in the top-left corner of your screen and select **About This Mac**.

## Distribution Installers



For installation assistance, refer to [troubleshooting](#).

|                |   |
|----------------|---|
| <b>Windows</b> | ▼ |
| <b>Mac</b>     | ▼ |
| <b>Linux</b>   | ▼ |

3. Run the installer.
  - a. You'll be prompted to choose an install location — a folder named `anaconda3`. Accept this.
  - b. Installation can take 15–20 minutes on an older machine or one with lots of installed programs/files. Don't stop the installation — only abort if it's taking noticeably longer than that.
  - c. You should not need to follow the Windows instruction about adding Anaconda to your `PATH`.
4. Open your Terminal. Steps 5 and 6 confirm everything installed correctly.
5. Type: `conda --version` You should see `conda 24.11.3` (or a later version) printed.
6. Then type: `python --version` You should see `Python 3.11.7` (or a later version) printed.
7. Create an environment by typing: `conda create -n codecamp python=3.12 -y`  
Wait to see something like this:

#### Downloading and Extracting Packages:

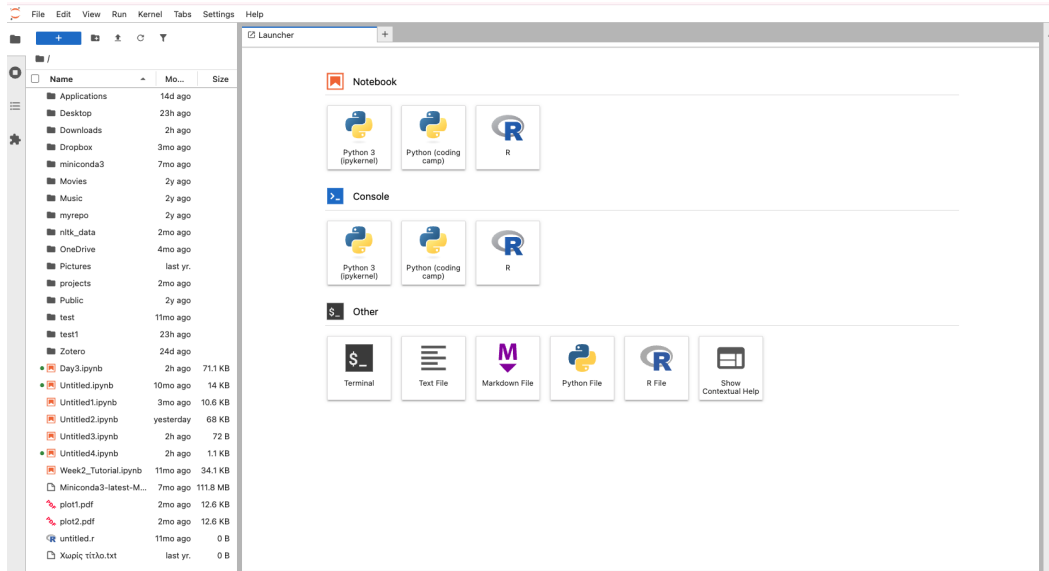
```
Preparing transaction: done
Verifying transaction: done
Executing transaction: done
#
# To activate this environment, use
#
#     $ conda activate testenv
#
# To deactivate an active environment, use
#
#     $ conda deactivate
```

8. Activate your environment by typing: `conda activate codecamp` (The screenshot below shows `testenv` because it was recorded in a different environment — your console should print `codecamp` instead.)
9. Confirm it worked: the prompt should change from `(base)` to `(codecamp)`, as shown here:

```
(base) elkarag@MacBook-Air-Eleni ~ % conda activate testenv
(testenv) elkarag@MacBook-Air-Eleni ~ % █
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10. Next, install JupyterLab:
  - a. Type `conda install -y jupyterlab ipykernel`
  - b. Open it by typing `jupyter lab`
  - c. You may be prompted to choose a browser to open it in — pick whichever you like.
11. You should see something like this:



**If something doesn't work, don't panic.** Check spelling very carefully, along with the exact typing of commands, spacing between words, etc. Try copying and pasting the commands exactly as written above.

If the problem persists, try uninstalling Anaconda and going through the process again (see the **Uninstalling** section below).

**If you're still facing issues, please email me at [karagiae@tcd.ie](mailto:karagiae@tcd.ie) to arrange a quick meeting to resolve any remaining issues.**

## Uninstalling

If you started the installation in class or before and things went sideways, you can — and should — try to uninstall everything and start from scratch.

To do this, make sure to do the following:

1. Delete Anaconda from the apps on your computer.
  - a. Windows: **Control Panel** → **Programs and Features** → uninstall Anaconda.
  - b. macOS: **Applications** → uninstall Anaconda.
2. Delete the anaconda3 folder.
  - a. Windows: **Users** → **<Your\_username>** → you should see a folder named anaconda3. Delete it. This can take several minutes.
  - b. macOS: Open Finder, go to your Home folder (the one with your username — you can get there quickly with **Shift + Command + H**), and find a folder named anaconda3. Delete it, then empty your Trash too.
3. Start over!

I tried to include all the problems we ran into today. If something else comes up, try pasting your error message into ChatGPT — it should be able to guide you to a solution. If that doesn't work out, please contact me.

**Happy coding!**